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**“Cut numbers”** were used extensively on the maritime CW bands: Every ship at sea sent its weather observations (“OBS”) every six hours (0000Z, 0600Z, 1200Z, 1800Z) to what ever shore station it was in contact with. These WX OBS were encoded into 5-digit number groups, always beginning with 99xxx.

After dozen or so vessels lined up and QRV to work one at a time, the OP would only have to send AA NN, and the ship at the head of the line would burst forth with their number groups, beginning with the 99xxx group.

These OBS were a perfect opportunity for vessels to use the abbreviated cut numbers, and were very much appreciated by shore station operators.

In Morse code, all numbers consist of five dots and/or dashes, which takes a fairly long time to send. "Cut numbers" provide an alternative way of representing numbers using (mostly) shorter Morse sequences that are faster to send. The actual sequences used are:

| Number | Normal Morse        | "Cut" number     | Equivalent character |
|--------|---------------------|------------------|----------------------|
| 0      | dah-dah-dah-dah-dah | dah              | T                    |
| 1      | di-dah-dah-dah-dah  | di-dah           | A                    |
| 2      | di-di-dah-dah-dah   | di-di-dah        | U                    |
| 3      | di-di-di-dah-dah    | di-di-di-dah     | V                    |
| 4      | di-di-di-di-dah     | di-di-di-di-dah  | 4                    |
| 5      | di-di-di-di-dit     | dit              | E                    |
| 6      | dah-di-di-di-dit    | dah-di-di-di-dit | 6                    |
| 7      | dah-dah-dit-dit-dit | dah-dit-dit-dit  | B                    |
| 8      | dah-dah-dah-di-dit  | dah-di-dit       | D                    |
| 9      | dah-dah-dah-dah-dit | dah-dit          | N                    |

Note that for all numbers except "5", the "cut" numbers simply replace all the dashes in the usual Morse representation of the number with a single dash. This is an easy way to remember the cut numbers. By far the most common in practice are "T" for "0" and "N" for "9", so you should be familiar with at least these